

02-13-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_w2n6pmX7YI
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Council Name: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: February 13, 2024

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, led roll call, and proceeded with the evening's agenda [00:08:04](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Hargrave, Ms. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin [[00:08:06](#)<U+2013>[00:12](#)].
 - **Absent:** Mr. Low [00:08:14](#).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. O'Neal / Board President (facilitating roll and meeting flow).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by student pledge leaders [00:07:29](#).
 - A musical performance was delivered by the Minority Educator Council of Muncie Community Schools choir [00:08:47](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** The consent agenda, including prior meeting minutes and routine items, was approved by voice vote [01:12:19](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Presentations & Reports

- [00:14:07](#) **Longfellow Elementary School Showcase & Academic Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gary Moore, Principal of Longfellow Elementary School, alongside students Legacy and Zoe.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Moore presented building updates centered on the theme “Every Little Step.” He highlighted the implementation of the Core Knowledge Language Arts (CKLA) curriculum, reporting significant increases in student proficiency benchmarks (rising from 15% to 33% mid-year) and high-growth tracking. The presentation also detailed weekly “learning walks” conducted alongside master teacher Faith Service to support professional development. Students Legacy and Zoe shared classroom projects, including a mock trial of *Don Quixote* and a poetry cafe showcasing “I Am” poems.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation; no formal board action required.
- [00:40:10](#) **Real Black Excellence (RBE) Community Partnership Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Stephen Hargrave, Founder of Real Black Excellence, joined by organizational staff and student interventionists.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Hargrave presented an overview of RBE’s community and in-school engagement work, noting after-school childcare, tutoring, mentoring, and support programs operating within schools like South View Elementary. He highlighted a collaborative upcoming jazz concert featuring Grammy-winning artist Kurt Ellum at the Cornerstone Center for the Arts, with 100 student tickets sponsored by the mayor and RBE.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation; no formal board action required.

Financial & Administrative Business

- [01:12:39](#) **January 2024 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer / Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the January actual financial results. The district received its state basic grant revenue (\$46.8 million based on an October 2023 enrollment of 4,951 students). Total cash balance at the end of

January stood at \$32.1 million. The state loan balance has been reduced to \$9.7 million and continues to be paid on schedule for a 2028 payoff.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:14:20](#).
 - [01:14:27](#) **Construction Manager Contract Award (Muncie Fieldhouse & Stadium Projects)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Richard Bowman (Core Construction).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff requested board approval to award the contract for Construction Manager as Constructor to Core Construction and CGA Associates of Indianapolis. The contract covers ongoing stadium updates (including locker room/restroom facilities on the north end of the football stadium, targeted for completion by August 9, 2024) and major renovations at the Muncie Fieldhouse including electrical updates, heating, and the historic addition of air conditioning, as well as surrounding sewer and water infrastructure improvements.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:16:30](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No members of the general public signed up or spoke during the open public comment period.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

Staff & Board Announcements

- [00:59:58](#) **Superintendent & Administrative Updates (Dr. K):**
 - **Scholastic Family Surveys:** Family engagement surveys are currently active in partnership with the George and Frances Ball Foundation, targeting a 40% completion rate per school.
 - **State of the Schools:** Scheduled for May 8 at Southside Middle School (reception at 6:00 PM, presentation at 7:00 PM).
 - **Communication Platform:** The district is piloting “Parent Square” as a unified communication tool for families, teachers, and administration.
 - **Black History Month Events:** Noted upcoming programs at Northside Middle School (featuring Ben Williams and band members on Friday at 2:00 PM) and Muncie Central High School (February 29 at 1:00 PM and 7:00 PM).
 - **NBA All-Star Basketball Display:** A 6-foot decorated fiberglass basketball honoring Muncie Central’s state championship history will be temporarily displayed downtown and subsequently relocated to the Fieldhouse.

- **Solar Eclipse Planning:** The administration is monitoring safety logistics, community traffic impacts, and potential schedule adjustments for the April 8 solar eclipse.
- **01:19:12 Board Recognition of Enrollment Growth:** Board leadership highlighted that MCS spring enrollment is up 134 students year-over-year (Spring 2023 to Spring 2024), praising district leadership, faculty, and staff.

Adjournment

- **01:31:32** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote.

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